

The Good Samaritan



SCRIPTURE · Luke 10:25–37

The Good Samaritan · ESV

MAIN MESSAGE

The parable of the Good Samaritan breaks down human divisions and confronts our instinct to limit love. Jesus redefines who our neighbor is: every human being made in God's image, even those we consider our enemies. True faith is not measured by religious status or right beliefs alone, but by genuine love for God and others that is lived out, even when it is costly or inconvenient. Jesus calls us not to ask who deserves our love, but to become compassionate, generous neighbors who love as He loved.

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

- 01 Where do you tend to draw lines around who deserves your time or care?
- 02 When helping others costs you something, how do you typically respond?
- 03 Where have you tried to limit who you are responsible for loving?
- 04 How do you justify not stepping up to meet certain needs put before you?

Discovering Truth

This parable begins with a man trying to justify himself. He wants to define the boundaries of who deserves love so he can feel secure in where he stands. Jesus shifts the focus completely. Instead of answering who qualifies, He shows what real love looks like in action. The issue is not defining whether someone else is worthy of love—it is examining whether a man will step in when a real need is in front of him.

01 · PARABLE

The Injured Man

The injured man represents complete vulnerability. He has nothing to offer—no status, no leverage, no benefit to anyone who helps him. His condition forces a decision. Will someone choose love and move toward him or turn a blind eye and walk past him?

02 · PARABLE

The Priest & Levite

The priest and the Levite represent men who look right on the outside but fail to act with love. They see the need clearly, but they choose to walk past it. Their reasons may have seemed valid—responsibility, risk, or time—but the result is the same. They prioritized their comfort and agenda over the person in front of them. Religious status, ministry involvement, or carefully reasoned moral justifications never excuse lovelessness.

03 · PARABLE

The Samaritan

The Samaritan represents costly love in action. He is the least expected to help, yet he is the only one who moves toward the need. He doesn't just feel sympathy, but quickly moves to act—he sacrifices time, money, comfort, and risk to care for the man. His response shows that real love is not theoretical; it is costly, intentional, and visible in what a man is willing to give.

This parable ultimately points to Jesus. Men are the ones on the road—broken, unable to fix themselves, and without hope. Jesus is the true Neighbor who crosses the ultimate divide—heaven to earth—stepped into our condition, and paid the full cost to bring us to life. He did not avoid us when it was inconvenient or costly—He came anyway. This is the standard. A man who understands that kind of grace does not walk past others—he moves toward them.

Key Points

01

Real love is not about defining who deserves it—it's about being a neighbor to love and serve anyone, even if it costs you something.

02

You can look serious about God and still miss what matters most if you prioritize comfort, efficiency, or control over people.

03

Jesus moved toward you when it cost everything, and a man who understands that love will do the same for others.

GROUP DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- | | |
|---|---|
| 01 How do you typically respond when there is no benefit to stepping in? | 04 How does seeing Jesus as the one who came for you change how you view others? |
| 02 What excuses do you use to avoid stepping into someone else's need? | 05 What would change if you treated people the way Jesus has treated you? |
| 03 How do you discern if someone really needs your help or if someone is taking advantage of their proximity to you? | |

Personal Reflection

Most men don't struggle with knowing what's right—they struggle with doing it when it costs something. It's easy to help when it's convenient, but that's not what Jesus calls for. The priest and Levite didn't reject the man—they just chose something else. That's what most men do. You stay focused, productive, and efficient, and you miss the person in front of you. Real love interrupts your life. It costs time, energy, and comfort. If your faith never shows up in how you treat people—especially the inconvenient ones—something is off.

PERSONAL REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- | | |
|---|--|
| 01 What is one excuse you've been using to avoid stepping in? | 03 What is one costly step you can take this week toward someone else's need? |
| 02 Where are you prioritizing productivity or comfort over people? | 04 How can you intentionally reflect the kind of love Jesus has shown you? |

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